TENDER PRJ-2026-003 · AIR QUALITY AND NOISE MONITORING NETWORK

Nimbrel Sensing

United Kingdom · Rank 3 of 3 · Report date: 25 October 2026

Not recommended



Not recommended: Nimbrel Sensing fails several mandatory requirements on measurement method, noise class, data hosting and bank security, and its low price buys a narrower offer.

Executive summary

Nimbrel Sensing offers six AQ-Pod S5 solar sensor pods, four NoiseNode C2 noise nodes, a cloud platform and a total bid of USD 552,600 excluding VAT. Its strengths are fast alarms, a bilingual public dashboard, 14 days of local storage and a timeline inside the 6-month limit. Technically, however, it replaces the EN reference gas methods with electrochemical sensors, offers MCERTS indicative rather than EN 16450 PM certification, supplies Class 2 rather than Class 1 noise terminals, and hosts data on a public EU cloud with 5-year retention instead of the Authority's servers with 10 years. Commercially it proposes a 12-month warranty, a 50 % advance without guarantee and London-issued bank security, all contrary to the RFP. The Authority should not award to Nimbrel Sensing on this bid and should proceed with the recommended bidder, Sabkha Environmental Systems.

Technical proposal

Weak

The proposal describes a dense, low-cost sensor network rather than the reference-grade station network the RFP specifies. Measurement principle, PM certification, noise class and hosting fail mandatory clauses, which the RFP says may lead to rejection. Several Comply and Partially comply entries in Annex A are not supported by the detail in the proposal, for example the gas methods and the report formats. The operational strengths are real but do not offset the measurement and data-governance gaps.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ Alarms by push, SMS and e-mail within 1 minute of the end of the averaging period, against the 5-minute limit.
  REQ-014 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ Public dashboard in Arabic and English and an open REST API, as the RFP requests for published data. REQ-016 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ 14 days of local storage with automatic back-fill over 4G, above the 7-day minimum; the backup link is not offered.
  REQ-009 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✓ Acceptance in month 4 meets the 6-month commissioning limit, although the 30-day trial is not stated as a duration.
  REQ-018 · Technical proposal p. 3

WEAKNESSES

- ✗ Electrochemical sensors are used for NO2, SO2 and O3, and PM is certified only as MCERTS indicative, with no EN 16450 certificates attached. Data may not be accepted as reference-equivalent in permit reporting to the Environment Agency.
  REQ-005, REQ-006, EM-01, EM-02 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✗ The noise terminals are Class 2 sound level meters with 10-second audio clips, with no all-weather microphone kit and no annual verification, against the mandatory Class 1 requirement.
  REQ-007, EM-07 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✗ Nimbrel Cloud runs on a public cloud in the EU (Dublin region), not on the Authority's servers, and data is kept online for 5 years, not 10. REQ-011, REQ-012, EM-05 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✗ No air-conditioned shelter and no stated battery runtime against the 2-hour UPS. Calibration uses monthly software model updates, with no 3-monthly gas calibration traceable to an ISO/IEC 17025 laboratory. REQ-008, REQ-019, EM-04 · Technical proposal p. 2
- ✗ Site visits within 72 hours with spares held in the UK, against the 48-hour response with spares in the State, and a 12-month warranty against the required 24.
  REQ-020, REQ-021, EM-11, EM-12 · Technical proposal p. 3

Commercial proposal

Weak

The total of USD 552,600 excluding VAT splits into supply and installation of USD 264,600 and a 3-year data service of USD 288,000, at USD 96,000 a year fixed for 3 years. The line is a data service and does not commit to station operation and maintenance. Payment is 50 % with the order and 50 % on installation, and the data service is invoiced yearly in advance, which is not tied to milestones and exceeds the 20 % advance cap. Both bid and performance security are issued by Thamesbridge Bank plc, London, which the RFP requires to be licensed in the State. At about a quarter of the other bids, the price reflects a narrower scope rather than better value.

STRENGTHS

- ✓ Prices are stated in USD excluding VAT, with supply and installation shown separately from the annual data service.
  REQ-026, REQ-028 · Commercial proposal p. 1
- ✓ Annual pricing is fixed for 3 years and bid validity is 120 days from the bid closing date, as the RFP requires.
  REQ-027, REQ-031 · Commercial proposal p. 1–2

WEAKNESSES

- ✗ A 50 % advance (USD 132,300 of the supply price) is due with the order, with no advance-payment guarantee, and the first-year data service of USD 96,000 is also invoiced in advance.
  REQ-029 · Commercial proposal p. 2
- ✗ The bid security of USD 25,000 and the 10 % performance security are issued by Thamesbridge Bank plc, London, not by a bank licensed in the State. REQ-030, REQ-032 · Commercial proposal p. 2

- ✕ The warranty is 12 months from acceptance, and no 3-year station O&M commitment is priced, so faults after month 12 would be unfunded. REQ-021, REQ-022 · Technical proposal p. 3; Commercial proposal p. 1

Technical vs commercial balance

Technical proposal: Weak | Commercial proposal: Weak

The technical proposal fails the RFP's core measurement and hosting requirements, which are pass/fail under the evaluation rules, so the price cannot be used to offset it. The commercial proposal is cheaper but also fails several mandatory terms, so a sharper price would not change the outcome. The two proposals reinforce each other: the cheapest offer is built on a narrower technical scope.

Value for money: The Authority would pay USD 552,600 for sensors that would probably need reference analysers, Class 1 noise terminals and a different hosting arrangement before the permit reports could rely on them. The saving against the other bids would be eroded by these additions and by the unguaranteed advance.

Key concerns for the client

1. **Permit data not accepted.** If the gas and PM methods are not reference-equivalent, the Environment Agency could dispute the port and Al-Sahil data, and the Authority could be forced to add or replace analysers mid-contract.
2. **Data outside Authority control.** Public-cloud hosting with 5-year online retention would leave the Authority without control of its records and create a gap in the permit record after year 5, requiring a costly migration.
3. **Cash exposed at signature.** A 50 % advance and first-year data fees invoiced in advance would be paid before delivery, and London-issued guarantees would be hard to enforce against a supplier in default.
4. **Slow and dependent field support.** A 72-hour visit, UK spares and reliance on Gulf Smart Systems, which is not contractually bound, could leave a failed station down for days and the Authority without a remedy.

Consultant's recommendation

We advise the Authority not to award the contract to Nimbrel Sensing on this bid. The mandatory failures on measurement method, noise class, hosting, retention, warranty and bank security require different equipment and a different service model, so they cannot be closed by clarification alone. The evaluation points to Sabkha Environmental Systems as the bidder to take forward, and the committee should proceed on that basis under the tender rules. The Nimbrel Sensing bid should be recorded as failing the pass/fail requirements.

CONDITIONS BEFORE AWARD

1. Accredited EN 16450 equivalence certificates for each PM analyser model, attached to the bid, and EN 14211, EN 14212 and EN 14625 analyser models for NO2, SO2 and O3.
2. IEC 61672-1 Class 1 noise terminals with an all-weather microphone kit and annual verification.
3. Deployment on the Authority's servers in its data centre, with 10-year retention of raw and validated data.
4. A 24-month warranty from acceptance and a 3-year station O&M commitment, with bid and performance security issued by a bank licensed in the State.

NEGOTIATION POINTS

1. Limit any advance to 20 % with an advance-payment guarantee from a bank licensed in the State.
2. Tie payments to delivery, acceptance and the 30-day trial, and invoice the data service in arrears.
3. Commit to 90 % valid hourly data per station, per pollutant and per calendar quarter, with service credits.
4. Require a 48-hour on-site response with spare analysers held in the State, under a service-level agreement.

CLARIFICATIONS TO REQUEST

1. A written authorisation or service agreement from Gulf Smart Systems.
2. Battery runtime at full load and a thermal test covering 0 °C to +50 °C.
3. Confirmation that alarms reach the HSE duty officer and that the REST API is documented.
4. Client contacts, station counts and installation years for each of the three reference networks.
5. Mapping of the six pods to sites AQ-1 to AQ-6 and the four noise terminals to sites N-1 to N-4.

Prepared by Mizan with Claude Haiku 5.5, acting as a procurement consultant, from the RFP, the vendor's proposal and Mizan's evaluation. Scores are computed by Mizan's scoring rules. AI-generated: verify key facts against the source documents before deciding.